

Unearthing Treasure: Finding Maps You Can't Live Without

Everybody is a geographer – we explore & navigate the world around us, make sense of it & visualize it.

Maps are tools to help us do that. Cartography is a living visual tradition, a way of seeing and interpreting the world. It is both an art and a science.

The three tasks of a cataloger who works to provide resource discovery for cartographic resources

Maps, nautical charts, aeronautical charts, atlases, platbooks, gazetteers, aerial photographs, satellite images, globes, relief models, geological sections, etc.

Description of a resource

Some data fields are similar to those that describe books, i.e. publisher, creator [= cartographer instead of author], physical size

Data fields that are unique to cartographic resources: Location = geographical coordinates as a reference system, coverage area, scale, projection, datum, how map data was collected & processed

Analysis of what we have in hand and what subjects are covered

Genre/form headings: Geological maps; Ethnographic atlases; Nautical charts; Quadrangle maps.

Subject headings: Railroads—Poland—Maps; Physical geography—California—Alameda County—Maps.

Subject added entry for a geographical name: Oakland Hills (Oakland, California) = a neighborhood within the city of Oakland — Easter Island — Cape Town (South Africa) — Maipo Canyon (Chile).

Classification

Cartographic resources are classed in the G-schedule (= Geography) of the Library of Congress classification system

The G-schedule classifies geographically. It assigns numbers to continents, countries, physical features, administrative regions, cities.

Examples:

Maps of California, G4360

Maps of California that cover a specific subject, G4361 [A road map of California is classed G4361.P2 = P2 is the subject cutter for roads; E63 signifies outdoor recreation; E635 signifies tourism; etc.]

Maps of physical features that are located in California, including parks and recreation areas, G4362 [Point Reyes National Seashore G4362.P59, Point Reyes Peninsula G4362.P593]

Maps of administrative regions located in California, G4363 [Alameda County G4363.A3]

Maps of cities, towns, places located in California, G4364 [Berkeley G4364.B5; an area within Berkeley, the University of California Berkeley campus G4364.B5:2U5]

Geographical names in the national U.S. name authority file (naf)

Two comprehensive online gazetteers function as knowledge base

Domestic and Antarctic geographical names (maintained by the United States Geological Survey = USGS)

Geographic Names Information System (GNIS)

<https://www.usgs.gov/tools/geographic-names-information-system-gnis>

Foreign geographic names (maintained by the National Geospatial-Intelligence Agency = NGA)

Geographic Names Server (GNS)

<https://geonames.nga.mil/geonames/GNSHome/index.html>

Locations in the Earth Sciences and Map Library

Case B	Map drawers for larger maps
Case D	Map drawers for smaller maps
Case 2	Chiefly geological maps with accompanying reports
Rolled maps	Wall maps and very large maps which do not fit into drawers
Reserve	In-house use only, valuable things we cannot replace
Reference	In-house use only, encyclopedias, gazetteers, cartography reference works
Stacks	Atlases, folded maps in pamphlet binders, books on geography, geology, cartography, and related topics
Topographic maps collection	California drawers are near the rolled maps
Aerial photographs collection	Most are contact prints shelved in filing drawers
Index maps collection	Visual indexes, useful to navigate large data sets like map series or sets of aerial photographs
Microforms collection	Maps on microfilm rolls or on microfiche
GIS workstation	Access to GIS data

Earth Sciences & Map Library, UC Berkeley <https://www.lib.berkeley.edu/visit/earth-sciences>

EART collections page <https://guides.lib.berkeley.edu/maps>

UC Library Search (Berkeley's online catalog) <https://search.library.berkeley.edu/>

EART hours: Currently open Monday to Friday, 11 AM to 5 PM

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